

III.

THE BABYLONIAN VERSION.

[illegible]

§ I. [I¹ am Darius, the great king, the king of the lands],² the Achaemenian, the king of kings,³ the Persian, the king of Persia.

§ II. Thus saith Darius, the king: My father is Hystaspes; the

1. § I. [a-na-ku¹ (m) Da-ri-ia-muš šarru rabû (u) šar mâtâtî]² (m) A-ġa-ma-ni-iš-' šar []³
šarrâni (pl) (amêlu) Par-sa-a-a šar (mâtû) Par-su § II. (m) Da-ri-ia-muš šarru ki-a-am
i-kab-bi at-tu-u-a abu-u-a (m) Uš-ta-as-pi abu ša (m) Uš-ta-as-pi

¹ An attempt is here made to restore as far as possible the missing portions of the Babylonian text from parallel passages. Where such authority is wanting the text has not generally been restored, but in some passages conjectural restorations have been suggested in the footnotes.

² At the beginning of the line there does not seem to be room for a greater number of signs than those conjecturally restored in the text. The traces of the last sign in the gap are possibly those of **W**, not **ΔΔ**.

³ The exact traces upon the rock read    , which should possibly be rendered *šarru ina naphar šarrâni(pl)*; but the traces which appear to read   are much weathered and may possibly represent an erasure by the engraver.